

summary of packages to be removed:

```
# emerge -Cav <pkgname>
```

Updating the system

For typical everyday updates, `--update` (`-u` for short) will update the packages listed on 'world':

```
# emerge -u world
```

You're probably wondering what 'world' is. Located at `/var/lib/portage/world`, this contains the list of packages you explicitly installed. Updating 'world', like above, will update only the software you have explicitly installed. To update every package installed on your system (including the ones listed in world), add `--deep` (`-D`):

```
# emerge -uD world
```

USE flags

USE flags are probably one of the top reasons why I use Gentoo. USE flags control what Portage should install for a package and its dependencies. For instance, the `www-client/links` package is a fast, lightweight text-and-graphic Web browser. It has these available USE flags: `{X bzip2 directfb fbcon gm jpeg livecd png sdl ssl svga tiff unicode zlib}`. If we set the USE flag to `X`, `links` will be installed with a graphical interface. Similarly, if we set a USE flag of `-X`, the graphical interface will not be installed; only the command-line version of the `links` will be installed.

Defining the USE flags is easy. To set USE flags system-wide, edit `/etc/make.conf` and add `USE=`, as follows (the following setting disables graphical interfaces for all packages that support them):

```
# nano /etc/make.conf
USE="-X"
```

If you want to set USE flags only for a specific package, create the file `/etc/portage/package.use` and add flags in the following manner (package name, and the USE flags for that

package, on one line):

```
# nano /etc/portage/package.use
www-client/links X
```

Packages must be recompiled after you modify USE flags. To recompile packages with the new USE flags, add `--newuse` (`-N`) as follows:

```
# emerge -N world
```

There is a precise introduction to Portage and USE flags in Part II of the Gentoo handbook [5].

Getting help with Gentoo

There is plenty of documentation, tutorials, and how-tos available at <http://www.gentoo.org/doc/en/> and the user-contributed Gentoo Linux wiki, <http://www.gentoo-wiki.com/>.

If you face any issues or have questions, you can search or post a query on the:

- Gentoo discussion forums <http://forums.gentoo.org/>
 - Gentoo IRC channels <http://www.gentoo.org/main/en/irc.xml>
 - Mailing lists <http://www.gentoo.org/main/en/lists.xml>
- For new *ebuilds* and bug reports, post them on Gentoo Bugzilla (<http://bugs.gentoo.org/>) 

Footnotes

- [0] <http://www.gentoo.org/proj/en/releing/installer/>
- [1] <http://distfiles.gentoo.org/releases/x86/autobuilds/current-iso/install-x86-minimal-20100216.iso>
- [2] <http://www.gentoo.org/doc/en/faq.xml#stage12>
- [3] <http://www.gentoo.org/doc/en/handbook/index.xml>
- [4] <http://www.gentoo.org/doc/en/handbook/handbook-x86.xml?part=1&chap=7>
- [5] <http://www.gentoo.org/doc/en/handbook/handbook-x86.xml?part=2&chap=1>

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